

From: Sukwant Grewal <Sukwant.Grewal@wolverhampton.gov.uk>
Sent: 19 Feb 2026 11:19:22
To: idoxdms@wolverhampton.gov.uk
Cc:
Subject: Fw: FW: [External]: Planning Consultation- 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, 25/01284/FUL
Attachments:

From:
Sent: Friday, December 12, 2025 10:44
To: Sukwant Grewal
Subject: FW: [External]: Planning Consultation- 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, 25/01284/FUL

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Good Morning Sukwant,

Please accept my apologies, I had noticed an error in my first response so please do go ahead and delete this and use the updated response below.

Thank You.

Kindest & Warmest Regards,

	Tarkan Mehmet-Ali 60255 Designing Out Crime Officer Birmingham Partnerships West Midlands Police M: 07767042982 T: 101 W : Tarkan.mehmetali@westmidlands.police.uk Working in partnership, making communities safer 
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From: Tarkan Mehmet-Ali
Sent: 11 December 2025 07:43
To: 'Sukwant Grewal' <Sukwant.Grewal@wolverhampton.gov.uk >
Subject: RE: [External]: Planning Consultation- 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, 25/01284/FUL

Good Morning Sukwant,

I have reviewed the application and associated documents relating to 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton. With a number of HMOs already established and nearby (currently 5 HMOs located on Woden Road), their close proximity and the proposed additional HMO risks shifting Woden Road away from a stable, family-oriented street towards a more transient, high-turnover environment. This undermines the established residential character of the area.

Clusters of HMOs—particularly in residential streets such as Woden Road can lead to higher levels of:

Noise disturbances.

Anti-social behaviour.

Police call-outs/calls for service.

The cumulative risk is significantly higher when multiple HMOs operate side-by-side or within the same stretch of road.

Currently 5 HMOs located on Woden Road: House numbers 2, 19, 54, 64 and 97 (Information provided by Council HMO list).

Parking Stress and Highways Impact - Woden Road experiences typical residential parking demand. HMOs often generate multiple vehicles per household, meaning that locating more than one HMO in close proximity can quickly overwhelm available on-street parking. This can lead to:

Pavement obstruction.

Conflict between residents.

Reduced visibility at junctions.

Increased safety concerns for pedestrians, including children walking to nearby amenities.

Noise, Disturbance, and Loss of Amenity - The cumulative late-night movement, visitors, and general activity associated with multiple HMOs could result in:

Loss of privacy for nearby households.

Sleep disturbance.

Increased background noise.

This is magnified when HMOs sit close together, as would be the case at 3 Woden Road.

Disproportionate Pressure on Local Services - Concentrating several HMOs (if not managed correctly) in the same area places added strain on:

- *Waste services.
- *Local policing.
- *Environmental health.

The proposed additional HMO at 3 Woden Road, could create a harmful cumulative impact, degrade residential amenity, increase crime and safety risks, and place unjustified pressure on the local area. The proposal is therefore incompatible with maintaining a balanced and safe residential environment and should be refused.

If, however, you are minded to grant/awarded planning, I would strongly recommend the below is conditioned in order for planning to be awarded.

HMO Recommendations

-

My Role as a Designing out Crime Officer is motivated to prevent crime, especially theft and burglary as well as other cases of repeated victimisation for the intended residents in order to ensure safety.

Vulnerable members of our society (persons suffering from various types of susceptibilities and issues such as drink and drugs problems, learning and mental health issues, ex-offenders etc.) can be housed in such lodgings as this. This raises fear that HMOs may not provide a safe environment for some elements of society. This is due to the lack of privacy and private space for tenants, having to share kitchens, communal and amenity spaces. In addition to this, HMOs are not conducive to long term living; therefore, a high turnover of residents is always expected. This usually leads to a lack of engagement, pride and ownership.

Security at home is a basic right for any tenant. Under the Homes (Fitness for Habitation) Act 2018, any property that cannot be secured against unauthorised entry would be considered a breach of the legislation, which could lead to action being taken against the landlord. It is therefore incredibly important that you get things right when it comes to HMO security.

Properties let in a shared capacity present different security risks from standard homes. With an HMO, not only must you provide security of an adequate nature for the overall property, you must also provide a safe method for tenants to be able to access common areas such as hallways, landings and kitchens, without threat of unauthorised entry by unwanted visitors.

For WMP to support this planning application and If planning permission/consent was to be granted, I would strongly recommend and require the following conditions to be met by the applicant (in order for planning to be awarded);

1. A strict vetting procedure should be put in place for tenants, including DBS checks, references, plus references from previous landlords including last landlord (if applicable).
2. A detailed tenancy document should be drafted outlining code of conduct and action that will be taken against residents for any breaches. If possible, residents should sign to a 6-month probation period whereby the landlord has the option to immediately evict any unruly tenants.
3. The proposed HMO should also meets the design specifications and physical security measures that are outlined in the SBD design Residential (Homes) Guide 2025. This information can be found at;

[Secured By Design - RESIDENTIAL GUIDE 2025](#)

4. **Access control** - One of the greatest issues with an HMO is the potential for unauthorised duplication of keys. The solution is a registered key system using restricted security keys. These are suitable for all types of lock. Patented for up to 20 years, the keys cannot be duplicated without an order signed by a stipulated signatory (normally the landlord/owner).

Restricted key systems can be suited, also known as ‘keyed alike’. This means they can be used to open groups of doors, so for example the entryway to the garden as well as the front door and any other common areas that require restricted access. This offers a great deal of convenience to the HMO tenant who will now only need minimal keys.

High security locks are a must, because individual tenants do not necessarily have full control over all the entryways to the property. For the ultimate protection choose a high security lock combined with a high security or restricted key system.

I strongly recommend the applicant is asked to provide PAS 24:2022 door sets fitted with TS 007 3 star rated cylinders to the external access doors of this building. I would also ask for PAS 24:2022 glazing for all windows if any are to be replaced or new ones installed.

I strongly recommend installing and fitting TS007 3-Star security rated locks (anti-drill, anti-bump, ant-snap) to all Dwelling and Resident main entrance doors. Further information can be found on the following links:

[Secured By Design TS007 S - Star Rated Locks](#)

[Secured By Design - RESIDENTIAL GUIDE 2025](#)

5. **Fire Regs & West Midlands Fire Services** – I strongly recommend (if not done so already), the applicant completes a site-specific fire risk assessment for the entire site footprint) I do think the applicant needs to provide more information on fire risk assessment and a strategy in place prior (fire doors, smoke detectors etc.). I would ask for the inclusion of smoke detection throughout and controlled fittings – Building Regulations etc.
6. **Lighting** - All External lighting installed on to the fabric of the building (around the boundary perimeter of the building) must be white LED dusk to dawn lighting. This type of lighting will allow you to be a “good neighbour” to other nearby residents and will assist in deflecting offenders from congregating in and around the car parks/store areas and help reduce offender anonymity.

Lighting at entrances and to the rear would be helpful in increasing safety and reducing the fear of crime. Lighting is a proven deterrent of crime and reduces offender anonymity. From the attached image of the dwelling there does not appear to be any form of lighting located at both the front and side (gated alley) area leaving these points extremely vulnerable and allowing offenders to easily conceal themselves during the night time. Further information can be obtained from the following links.

[pcpi lightning guide web.pdf \(securedbydesign.com\)](#)

[Lighting Against Crime](#)

7. **CCTV** - I strongly recommend installing a full CCTV Scheme (to cover all front side and rear areas). A CCTV system will also provide critical footage that can be used as evidence in the event that somebody tries to break into the HMO property. It also gives control over enforcing rules at your premises; ensuring tenants don't damage the property. Advice on CCTV can be found at:

<https://www.policesecuritysystems.com/>

<https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/data-protection-self-assessment/cctv-checklist/>

8. **Cycle storage** – Cycle crime has seen a significant national increase. The inclusion of secure cycle storage within the development delivers clear crime prevention benefits and aligns with national and local planning policies aimed at creating safe, inclusive, and sustainable environments. By incorporating principles of target hardening, surveillance, and defensible space, the proposal will:

- Reduce opportunities for bicycle theft and vandalism;
 - Enhance user confidence and perceptions of safety; and
 - Support the development's compliance with Secured by Design standards and NPPF guidance on crime prevention through good design.
- Further information can be obtained from the following links.

9. **Bin Storage** – I strongly recommend that securely stored refuse arrangements are made for the site. If not secured correctly, Offenders can weaponize refuse bins in a number of ways;
- *Can be used to negotiate and scale walls and fences - next to a wall or fence, especially where there's a flat roof near a window where offender could gain access properties.
 - *If bins are left out unsecure, it can highlight to offenders that the home maybe vacant and/or without any occupants being at home.
 - *Wheelie bins have a generous capacity, and they're easy to move, so they're quite a convenient way for offenders to transport stolen goods undetected.
 - *Bin Raiding is where someone searches the contents of bins that are not theirs. Bin raiders are looking for semi valuable items from household and business bins to clean up and sell on, or to get personal details. A frequent problem associated with bin raiding is identity theft.
10. **Rent with Confident (RWC): Wolverhampton City Council** - I strongly recommend the applicant joins the scheme. The primary aim of the scheme is to encourage and promote good standards of accommodation in the private rented sector which meets legal requirements and good management standards.

It will provide public recognition for landlords showing that they have properties that meet or exceed the accreditation standard thus providing a good choice of quality accommodation for tenants living in the Wolverhampton area. Further information can be obtained from the following links.

<https://www.rentwithconfidence.org.uk/about-rwc/index.html>

[How do become accredited?](#) | [Accreditation Pack](#) | [Landlords/Agents](#) | [Rent with Confidence](#)

- **Construction Site Security** – Construction sites no matter how big or small continue to be targeted. A secure, robust fit for purpose boundary treatment during the construction phase will assist in having the first and most important layer of defence. Further information can be obtained from the following links.

[Secured By Design Construction site security guide](#)

[National Business Crime Centre Construction Site Security Guidance](#)

We share a joint responsibility to work towards a safer wolverhampton. I'd like to remind you of your obligations under Section 17 of the Crime and Disorder Act 1998, which requires authorities to consider the impact of their decisions on crime and disorder, including anti-social behaviour and serious violence. You can review the legislation on the official government site : <http://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1998/37/section/17>

This preventative legislation remains highly relevant for local authorities. Importantly, crime is a material consideration in planning decisions and should be treated as such.

I have no further comments to make at this stage of the process, please do not hesitate to contact me at your convenience, should you require any further information and assistance.

Kindest & Warmest Regards,



Tarkan Mehmet-Ali | 60255

Designing Out Crime Officer

Birmingham Partnerships

West Midlands Police

M: 07767042982 **T:** 101

W : Tarkan.mehmetali@westmidlands.police.uk

Working in partnership, making communities safer



From: Sukwant Grewal <Sukwant.Grewal@wolverhampton.gov.uk>
Sent: 02 December 2025 13:19
To: Tarkan Mehmet-Ali <tarkan.mehmetali@westmidlands.police.uk>
Subject: [External]: Planning Consultation- 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, 25/01284/FUL

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Hi Tarkan,

I would be pleased to receive your comments on the following application:

Planning Application Number: 25/01284/FUL
Proposal: Demolition of side extension, ground floor rear extension and Change of Use of existing dwelling C3 to 6 person HMO C4 (House in Multiple Occupation) with associated bins & cycle facilities.
Site Address 3 Woden Road, Wolverhampton, WV10 0AU

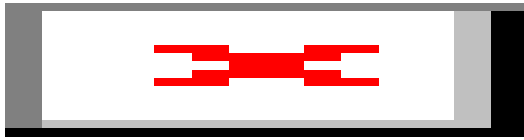
Kind regards

Sukwant Grewal
Assistant Planner
Tel: 01902 551676

[E-mail: Sukwant.Grewal@wolverhampton.gov.uk](mailto:Sukwant.Grewal@wolverhampton.gov.uk)

City of Wolverhampton Council

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